FISHING FOR SUCCESS

Empowering the fisheries sector and the national livestock census will be top priority

By HIMANSHU SHEKHAR



Consider this. The share of livestock in the agriculture and allied sector GVA (Gross Value Added) has risen from 24.4 per cent in FY15 to 30.2 per cent in FY22. India is also the world's largest milk producer and home to the world's largest livestock population. Fisheries, too, is a sunrise sector, witnessing a record catch of 17.5 MT in FY23 (8 per cent of global production) and contributing 6.7 per cent to the agriculture GVA. It was recognising this very contribution of the sectors in providing livelihoods and their role in the country's economic growth that the ministry of fisheries, animal husbandry and dairying was formed in May 2019. Its mandate is simple: ensure these sectors now go from strength to strength. ■

WHAT NEEDS TO BE DONE

EFFECTIVE PMMSY The Rs 20,050 crore Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana was launched to strengthen the fisheries sector and empower the fishermen communities. Projects under the scheme have seen a decline of late

EXPAND KCC COVERAGE Kisan Credit Card (KCC) took in people involved in animal husbandry, dairying and fisheries in 2018-19, but coverage is still less than optimum

LIVESTOCK CENSUS The 21st national livestock census is due in 2024. The census is a key source of data for implementation of livestock welfare programmes

AHID FUND The Animal Husbandry Infrastructure Development (AHID) fund was created to incentivise private investments in this sector. It still lags in state-of-the-art infrastructure

SVAMITVA The Survey of Villages and Mapping with Improvised Technology in Village Areas (SVAMITVA) scheme to provide a 'record of rights' to rural households ends in 2025 and the panchayati raj ministry has to finish demarcation of inhabited (*abadi*) land

RAJIV RANJAN SINGH, *69* | JD(U)

Minister of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying; Panchayati Raj

↘ **Friendly fire** Munger MP Rajeev Ranjan, a.k.a. Lalan Singh, was staring down the barrel five months back when he was ousted as JD(U) president. There was talk of a tiff with Nitish Kumar over his friends in the RJD, but then there were some who said Lalan aided the party's return to the BJP camp. He's enjoying the winner's spoils now

Ministers of State



S.P. SINGH BAGHEL, *63* | BJP

↘ A two-time MP from Agra, Baghel was MoS in Modi 2.0 too. The stint as UP's livestock and fisheries minister should come in handy in his new role



GEORGE KURIAN, *63* | BJP

↘ Kurian has been part of the BJP in Kerala since the '80s. His Syro-Malabar church helped the BJP win its first LS seat in Thrissur. Misses out on panchayati raj, gets minority affairs